

Coach First

Investor Data, API and Platform Costing

Prepared 8 July 2026. Purpose: show what it costs to turn Coach First from a strong demo into a live Head Coach Appointment OS.

Core thesis	Data gets the club to the shortlist. Private football intelligence tells them whether to appoint.
Commercial layers	Full-service search; GBP10k-GBP15k Head Coach Assessment Pack; subscription intelligence; coach-side profile/data room.
Investment rule	Buy data that strengthens, qualifies, evidences or packages the final appointment recommendation.
90-day ask	GBP20k-GBP40k preferred investor budget for data, scraping, transcription, storage, PDF hardening and one premium data/video partner quote.

1. Product Direction

- The app should operate as a source-to-decision system: raw intelligence enters once, is verified, then becomes profile claims, assessment evidence, confidential material or board-pack content.
- The coach portal is the supply-side moat: coaches and agents add presentations, training clips, game model documents, staff network and feasibility details before a club asks.
- The relationship layer is the USP: agent calls, CEO/sporting director references, journalist context and trusted football conversations must be stored with source tier, confidence, sensitivity and contradiction status.
- The board pack stays simple: strengths, risks, recommendation, confidence, missing evidence, cost/feasibility and next action.

2. Costed Data Stack

Need	Provider examples	Public pricing / range	Recommendation
Core fixtures, results, standings, squads	API-Football	Plans start at \$19/month; all plans include competitions/endpoints.	Keep as lean base layer for broad football coverage.
Premium event/video/scouting data	Hudl Wyscout, StatsBomb, Opta/Stats Perform	Mostly quote-led. Wyscout publishes package tiers but API/custom data requires quote.	Do not buy blind. Get quotes and test against 20 coach profiles.
News monitoring	NewsAPI	Developer free for dev only; Business \$449/month; Advanced \$1,749/month.	Use free/dev for prototype; budget Business for production monitoring.
Google/news/social scraping	Apify, SerpApi	Apify Starter \$29/month, Scale \$199, Business \$999 plus usage. SerpApi \$25/1k, \$75/5k, \$150/15k searches.	Start with Apify/SerpApi for targeted coach queries; avoid large legal-risk scraping until policies are clear.
Call/video transcription	OpenAI, AssemblyAI	OpenAI mini transcription approx \$0.003/min; AssemblyAI free tier includes large trial allowance and custom/pay-as-you-go scale.	Use transcription immediately for agent calls and Zooms; it directly feeds intelligence inbox.
AI extraction/classification	OpenAI API	OpenAI pricing varies by model; web search tool listed at \$10/1k calls.	Use cheaper models for extraction, expensive models only for pack drafting/reasoning.
Social listening	Brandwatch, Talkwalker, Meltwater alternatives	Brandwatch is custom-plan/quote-led; third-party benchmarks often place enterprise social listening in five figures/year.	Treat as Phase 3. Start with targeted public monitoring, not enterprise social suite.
Storage and data room	Supabase Storage/Vercel Blob/S3	Low at demo scale; rises with video volume and egress.	Store metadata now; keep large videos linked or object-stored with access controls.

3. Recommended Budget

Scenario	Monthly tools/data	One-off build budget	What it buys
Lean investor-ready	GBP200-GBP900	GBP5k-GBP10k	API-Football, targeted scraping/search, transcription, AI extraction, storage, manual analyst review.
Serious club pilot	GBP2k-GBP8k	GBP20k-GBP40k	News monitoring, structured source graph, coach portal uploads, access controls, pack versioning, one data/video quote.
Institutional product	GBP8k-GBP25k+	GBP75k-GBP150k+	Premium event/video data, organisation seats, audit trail, automated ingestion, legal review, enterprise monitoring.

4. Build Priorities

- Close the intelligence loop: every raw item must promote to feed, profile claim, assessment evidence, confidential material or relationship log.
- Add source expiry and contradiction flags so stale agent intelligence does not silently drive recommendations.
- Make coach portal invitations real: coach-owned login, upload storage, review status, share controls, and analyst approval.
- Add board-pack versioning: every pack should have prepared-by, version, source appendix, excluded evidence count and redaction state.
- Add organisation model only after investor demo: club seats, roles, access logs and external data-room requests.

5. Investor Ask

Ask for a 90-day product/data budget rather than a vague software budget. The right ask is GBP20k-GBP40k: enough to harden the app, create the source/claim/evidence graph, run targeted ingestion, buy transcription/search/news tools, and get serious quotes from Wyscout/StatsBomb/Opta without committing to a large annual deal too early.

6. Source Notes

- API-Football pricing: <https://www.api-football.com/pricing>
- NewsAPI pricing and terms: <https://newsapi.org/pricing> and <https://newsapi.org/terms>
- Apify pricing: <https://apify.com/pricing>
- SerpApi pricing: <https://serpapi.com/pricing>
- OpenAI API pricing: <https://developers.openai.com/api/docs/pricing>
- AssemblyAI pricing: <https://www.assemblyai.com/pricing>
- Hudl Wyscout pricing page: <https://www.hudl.com/products/wyscout/pricing>
- Brandwatch plans: <https://www.brandwatch.com/plans/>